

#CLASSIFIEDS

DATA STACKER

Talk stocks stack SATS

PlebLab
STARTUP DAY
GUADALAJARA
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The next wave of Bitcoin Builders in
Mexico's Silicon Valley.

August 20-21, 2026 · Guadalajara, Jalisco, México
Bitcoin Lightning Hackathon -- PlebLab Startup Day

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MAY 23 - MAY 29

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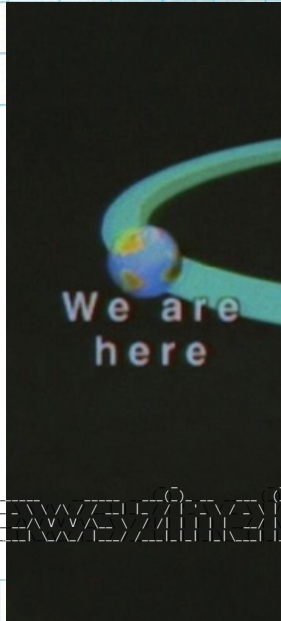
WELCOME

EDITOR'S PICK

trip report: northern cyprus

3463 sats \ 4 comments \ @leo 24 May Travel

DO YOU FIND YOURSELF MISSING THE ACTION OF THE WEEK, THE STORIES, UPDATES, RELEASES, SCANDALS, AND TIPS THAT APPEAR DAILY ON THE FRONTIER WE CALL STACKER NEWS?



MISSING THEM, NOT ABLE TO CATCH UP TO THEM, TO READ EACH WORD AND ABSORB EACH THOUGHT, BECAUSE YOUR LIFE IS FULL AND BRIGHT, AND HOPE CALLS YOU FORWARD INTO EVERY OPPORTUNITY?

stacker newszine for you

I GOT YOU, LIKE DON'T EVEN WORRY. THIS IS A BITE-SIZED TAKEAWAY OF THE BEST THINGS THAT GOT PUT UP ON THE SITE THIS WEEK. IT'S POSSIBLE TO GLANCE THROUGH THIS WHILE YOU MAKE A DEPOSIT, HAVE A GLASS OF TEA, MAYBE THAT'S WHAT YOU DO, IDK. YOU'LL ENJOY A GRAPHIC DISPLAY OF THE ARTICLES, AND YOU'LL ALSO BE LINKED BACK TO EACH OF THEM TO PLACE A COMMENT OF YOUR OWN IF YOU SHOULD SO CHOOSE.



Not every time I travel I'm able to actually use Bitcoin. But sometimes I discover interesting-enough and unlikely Bitcoin communities that make me want to share regardless, and Stacker News seems to be the perfect place.

I recently traveled to the Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus (TRNC, or KKTC in Turkish). I heard grand stories of widespread Bitcoin adoption, and the stories somewhat fit what I knew about the place. A small strip of land, formally independent from Turkey, but recognized by nobody else, with a highly liberal visa regime, no currency of its own, and the geographical isolation of an island, divided in two parts by a concrete wall. The economy relies almost entirely on international tourists from places with poor or no financial infrastructure of their own, the largest bill isn't even worth US\$5, which the country doesn't print it itself, but is imported from its only economical and political partner, Turkey.



✈ There are multiple flights a day scheduled from Istanbul every day, but I wasn't able to book most of them through Travala or even the airline directly. I doubt they ever took off. I ended up on a Pegasus flight that I booked through Travala with sats.

🇬🇧 Travala does not list accommodation in Northern Cyprus, and their customer support tells me this is due to their wholesaler (Expedia) boycotting the place. Bitcoin Travel lists a small handful of places, but they are unbookable. I emailed a hotel that I heard accepts Bitcoin, but never heard back. I ended up finding a cheap and nice place in the old town of Lefkoşa (Nicosia) on Booking, but that means I have to pay with a debit card.

📶 Nadanada does not sell specific eSIMs for Nicosia, but their Euro bundle does include Northern Cyprus, and it indeed works. Dracotel does not indicate anything about Northern Cyprus on their website, but the eSIM works. Silent Link fails me, and cannot connect to any network....

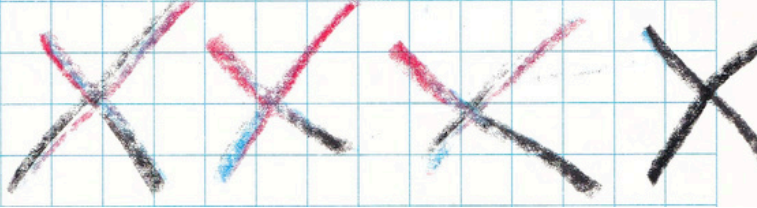
📞 A cell phone shop that claimed to accept "Tether, Bitcoin and Nigerian Naira (???)" said they would take my Bitcoin, but when I tried to buy a phone charger, all they could give me was a screenshot of a Tether on Tron address.

🚗 A luxury car dealership didn't hesitate when I asked, but I figured my channels aren't girthy enough for the latest BMW 7 series....



how sweden learned to love capitalism (wsj, tom fairless)

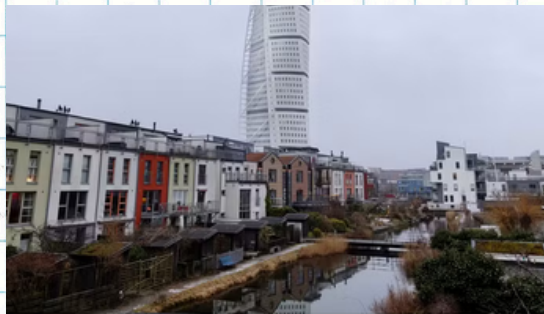
3478 sats \ 12 comments \ @denlillaapan 23 May
Politics_And_Law econ



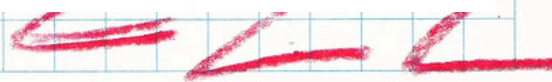
Back when Bernie Sanders was out shouting in the media -- and said things like "We should be more like SWEDEN!" -- our Cato-affiliated friend, Johan Norberg, #607347, #969787, wrote op-eds and went on television saying... YEES, America should be more like Sweden: you know, more free trade, less onerous bureaucracy, better protection of property, integrity of government etc, and all the other ways in which Sweden outperforms 'Murica in economic freedom (= every metric but size of government. Duh.)

Oh man, do I have things to say about this topic -- and this article specifically.

Stupid attention-grabbing headlines, of course, because Sweden (and Swedes) **do not love capitalism**... though they seem somewhat less outspokenly hostile to it, compared to some loud-mouthed idiots elsewhere...



WORLD • EUROPE
The World's Most Surprising Capitalist Makeover Is Under Way in Sweden



It's a nice long read, touching on some select current-affairs topics (gang violence, private schools, inequality, economic miracle, growth challenges)... though *completely* overdoes the "privately operated-publicly financed" schooling and hospital.

That's NOT what's interesting about Sweden's 50-year pivot from Big(gest!) Government!

THIS history should be the focus, not political squabbles over whether some high school is too lavish with public funds

< Sweden didn't always have a big public sector. The country climbed from being one of the poorest to the third-richest country in Europe over 100 years through 1970 without high levels of taxation. But starting in the 1960s, the center-left Social Democratic Party --which dominated the country's postwar politics--sharply raised taxes and spending, ultimately taking government spending as high as 70% of GDP by the 1990s. The changes triggered a long period of weak growth, stagnant after-tax incomes and ballooning budget deficits and debt that culminated in a banking crisis in the early '90s.

< They included cuts to unemployment benefits and housing subsidies and the privatization of public services, as well as tax cuts and a reform of the pension system to make it more affordable. Strict limits were imposed on government debt. (Sweden's debt to GDP is a meager 36%, compared with 129% for the U.S.) In the mid-2000s, the government eliminated wealth and inheritance taxes.

That history is fantastic. 1870-1970, under comparatively _small_ government, Sweden had the (second-fastest... Japan fucked us) per-capita GDP growth ever recorded. And then Icarus flew too close to the sun, lefties thought they could do nothing wrong, and spent a few decades ruining _a lot_.

The backlash/pinball from some financial and banking crises in the ~1990s and constant deregulation/abolishing harmful taxes and lowering rates since have been a godsend.

America should take note of this story

(That debt ratio, too, is, all things considered, pretty impressive.)

...

Anyway, interesting read if all you know about Sweden is Abba, IKEA, and socialist utopia.



TOP COMMENT

139 sats \ 5 replies \ @kepford 23 May

...Sweden went full socialist in the 70s. IE real socialism, not capitalism with a large welfare state which is what they are now. It didn't go well. Shocker.

So they reformed and began to prosper again....

The Democratic Socialist point to Sweden as an example of socialism but it isn't a positive one. It actually seems to not only NOT be socialism but it is an example of how when tried in a great place where you'd think it would work it failed.

TOP POST

more square adventures... spending via lightning is so interesting & exciting

4072 sats \ 21 comments \ @028559d218 24 May lightning

Another day another coffee, another Square terminal accepting bitcoin...

Lightning is such an amazing, remarkable addition to bitcoin and the options and opportunities it provides are great. Every day I use lightning I am more and more positive about its future and integration with day-2-day life. We now have non-kyc markets with lightning (hodl hodl and robosats), merchants that are rolling out lightning acceptance everywhere (I can attest to this) and better tools and wallets on a phone...

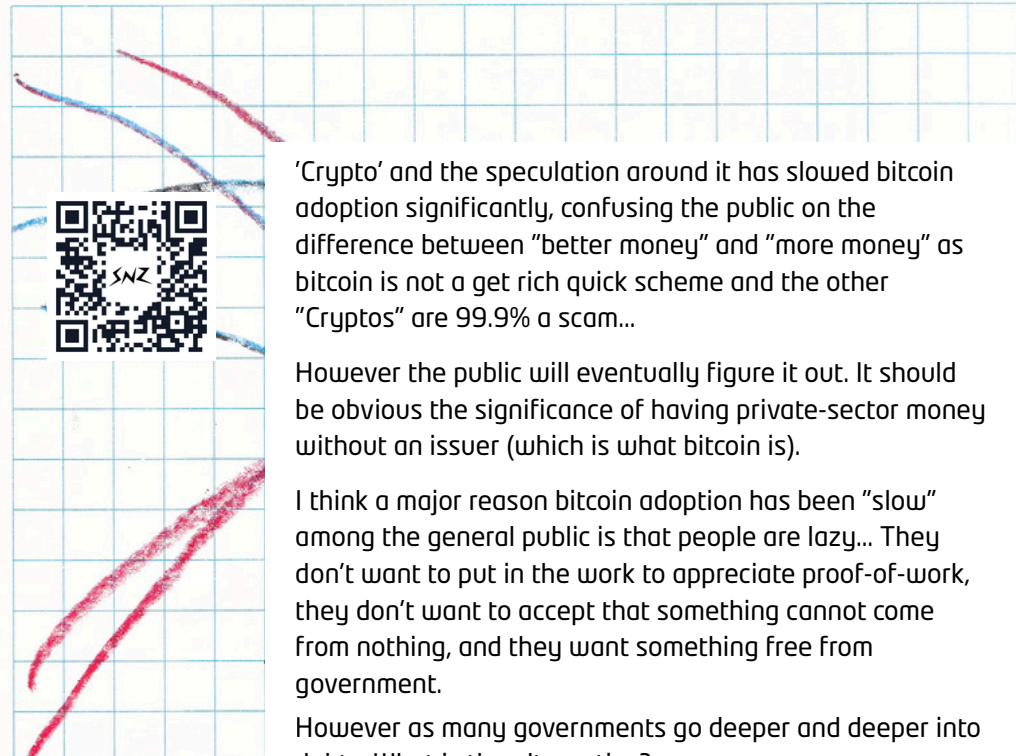
That do more things and make lightning more seamless and easy to use. In addition, the privacy lightning affords is significant while still leaving the 'base chain' transparent to verify supply and macro-activity throughout an economy.

Overseas travel, overseas merchants, VPNs, software products, social media and forums (of which stacker news is the best), physical capital (satscards and opendimes) lightning swaps and ecash... Its a remarkable growing ecosystem you can do more and more with.

I don't know anyone in person meaningfully interested in bitcoin... Much less anyone else who knows what lightning is... but I think it is just a matter of time before we have a significantly greater number of people "come to Jesus" and when I say Jesus I mean Bitcoin.

The fact that I can send and receive sats here on stacker news, and then take those same sats and buy a coffee, use them to open a lightning channel, rent a lightning channel, donate to a developer, pay for an on-chain transaction almost instantly all the while leaving L1 for verifiability and security...

Is nothing short of remarkable. I have said this before but one day lightning will come to YouTube and sites like it... And *eventually* people will love it once they experience it themselves the effect will be overwhelming and vast.



'Crypto' and the speculation around it has slowed bitcoin adoption significantly, confusing the public on the difference between "better money" and "more money" as bitcoin is not a get rich quick scheme and the other "Cryptos" are 99.9% a scam...

However the public will eventually figure it out. It should be obvious the significance of having private-sector money without an issuer (which is what bitcoin is).

I think a major reason bitcoin adoption has been "slow" among the general public is that people are lazy... They don't want to put in the work to appreciate proof-of-work, they don't want to accept that something cannot come from nothing, and they want something free from government.

However as many governments go deeper and deeper into debt... What is the alternative?

I was in a busy shopping area in the pacific northwest recently... Looking for square merchants for a coffee or a place to get lunch. So I stepped into a busy coffee shop, walked up to the counter after I saw the Square terminal and asked...

"Does your square terminal accept Bitcoin?"

One would think that people would grasp the remarkable ability to actually pay in non-state money for a coffee, transact in it, hold it yourself in a way that promotes individual sovereignty...

"No the terminal is off. That isn't enabled, that is off, it doesn't work we don't take that..."

And they frowned at me. *Frowned.* it was as if I asked them something rude or inappropriate.

So I said "thank you very much, perhaps next time" and left being as polite as I could.

Fast forward a few days...



I'm in the American south, and once again go Square-hopping looking for coffee shops.

Aha they have square...

"Yes do you have nitro cold brew?"

"Yes we do."

"Do you accept Bitcoin?"

"Accept what? No I don't think we take that, sorry..."

"Can you check please? All the square terminals are accepting Bitcoin now."

"OK... Actually we do take that I see that."[

The QR code appears on the screen after I select a nice tip... Which I scan with my NON CUSTODIAL WALLET.

And 10-15 seconds later I have paid in bitcoin, in a private-sector money which the Fed cannot manipulate, in a random coffee shop in the American south, with many Lightning hops to Square's (what appears to be) blinded Lightning invoice.

Once again I am amazed. Not because of a QR code... But because of the growing ecosystem and possibilities for freedom that sound, digital money provides.

I think there will eventually be another major financial crisis, not because of the Fed specifically (I actually think most of the people that work at the Fed are good people, well-meaning individuals) but because the United States congress is completely incompetent. Eventually foreigners will figure out that buying treasuries is a terrible idea and there is a new Risk Free rate and the closest one can achieve to that is Bitcoin in Cold Storage, on-chain. Then all the risk in financial markets will be repriced, it will be terrifying and glorious, and it will be a big deal.

I talk to my friends not about Bitcoin (it is too much for them) but about Gold which is something they can understand and I highlight how the interest payments alone on a growing debt... are unsustainable. They nod their heads and agree with me, after I explain the numbers simply don't work over the next 10 years (larger and larger interest payments, higher interest rates, borrowing 7% of GDP a year) on an already very large Federal Debt. But I don't think they understand how this problem will effect all Americans and quite seriously and soon.

All we can do, and are doing, is support developers and businesses who give people a monetary alternative which is what Bitcoin is.

I am so glad that I "found" stacker news, I think many of us will look back at this "in-between" time with amazement...

I do.

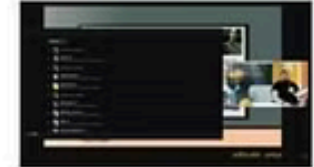
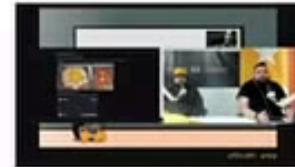
History is in the making and I am proud and humbled to be a part of it.

CONTINUED

meme monday - top meme goes in the newsletter

394 sats \ 4 comments \ @sn 25 May memes

22 sats \ 0 replies \ @Oxbitcoiner 25 May



***watch stacker news live
every friday
on texas time***

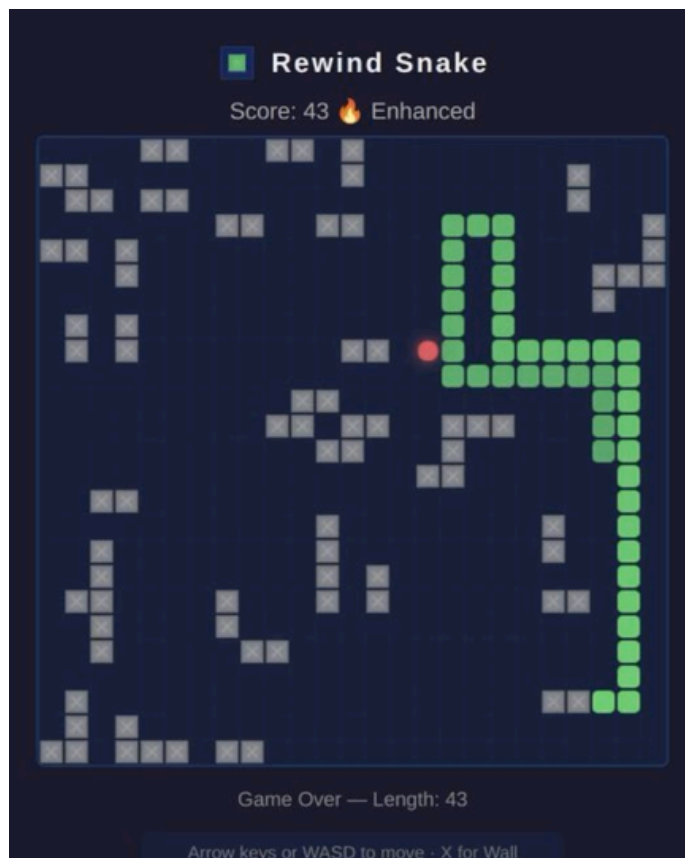
my first game built entirely with a local llm:

  **rewind snake**

5447 sats \ 2 comments \ @rolznz 25 May AI



Qwen 3.6 35B A3B: the first time for me that a local model has felt both smart AND fast enough to actually be usable.



Win sats!

- 10,000 sats to the highest score on Normal Mode
- 10,000 sats to the highest score on Enhanced Mode

Play it here:
<https://rolznz.github.io/rewind-snake/>

To be eligible, enter your lightning address in the high score entry. Winner announced Wednesday morning US.

Making a game was just a test.

What I really have been after is self-sovereign AI - building on a mid-tier laptop is now possible.

My setup: Qwen3.6-35B-A3B-UD-IQ3_XXS on a single NVIDIA RTX 4060 mobile - 8GB VRAM (A mid-tier laptop graphics card)

Using llama.cpp, built from source:

```
./build/bin/llama-server -m Qwen3.6-35B-A3B-UD-IQ3_XXS.gguf -ngl 99 -np 1 -fa on -ctk q8_0 -ctv q8_0 -c 131072 --host 0.0.0.0 --port 8088 -ncmoe 38 --no-mmap
```

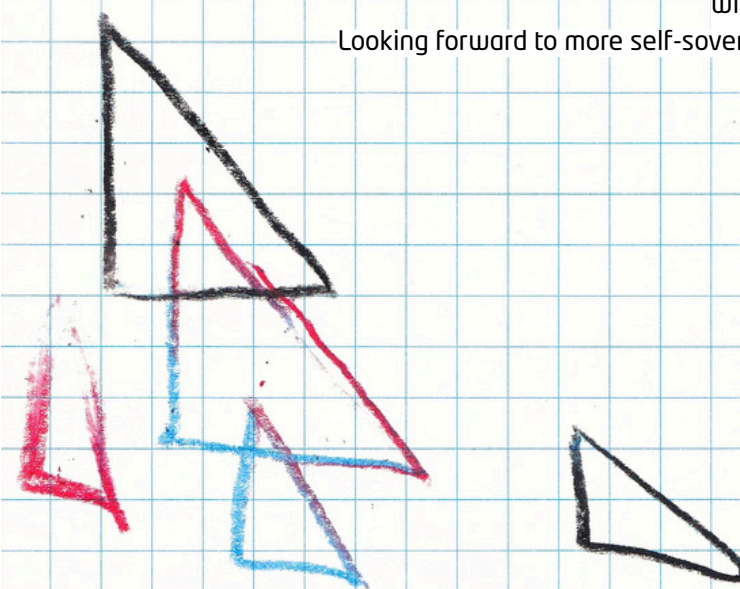
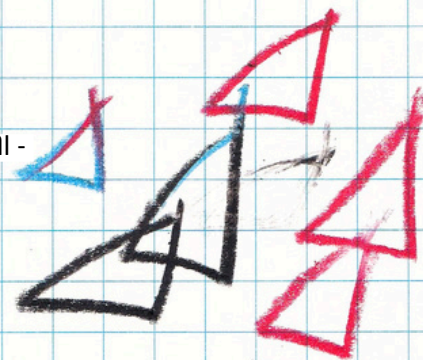
(Any ideas how I can optimize it more? MTP was not successful for me - 15% faster but much higher memory usage)

I built the app with PI agent. It's great for local-LLM dev because it doesn't waste context.

I also connected PI agent to Alby's builder and payments skills. Now I can build payment apps, and my agent can have budgeted, private access to my wallet.

I also built a simple "second brain" - a place to brainstorm and dump ideas without being spied on.

Looking forward to more self-sovereign AI experiments!



TOP POST

a crude demo: impact of disclosing your state and birthdate

14.2k sats \ 24 comments \ @optimism 25 May privacy

A very basic example to show the impact to your **k-anonymity** when you disclose your location at the state level, and then your birthdate.

> Your "anonymity group" (k) is the number of people who share the exact same combination of traits as you. If $k=1$, you are uniquely identified.

Assumptions

We start with 3 assumptions to ease it up:

1. You're in the US - larger countries do better, smaller do worse.
2. You're in an averagely populated US state (MA or IN) - larger states do better, smaller states do worse
3. People live 80 years and the age pyramid is a column, so that we don't have to bother with segment size. In reality, if you're young, your group is smaller due to declining birth rates, and the same if you're old, due to deaths.
4. You're not born on Feb 29th.

Calc

Total US population: 335,000,000

Number of US states: 50

Number of birth dates: 80 years * 365.25 days/year = 29,220

Here we go:

To start with, we're one out of 335M people. That's a huge anonymity set, great! But now we disclose our state, because compliance:

$$335,000,000 / 50 = 6,700,000$$

Now we're one out of 6.7M people. That's still huge! No problem.

But now we disclose our birth date, because we live in a nanny state and we must:

$$6,700,000 / 29,220 = 229$$

Now we're one in 229 people. This is extremely fragile.

Why is this fragile you say?

Because every time you slip up, this gets narrowed down:

- You accidentally disclose your gender: down to $229 / 2 = 114$
- Your spouse discloses the same data from the same IP address: you're done.
- You mentioned the bar you went to last night: you're done.
- You mention Bitcoin: you're done.
- Instead of state, you passed your zipcode: *you're done*.

PS: clean your cookies sometimes on top of never mentioning your location or birth date, to anyone.



TOP COMMENTS

111 sats \ 8 replies \ @0xbitcoiner 25 May
Poisoning the data is the way to go!

85 sats \ 0 replies \ @cryptosensei 26 May
Okay it's so scary how we can doxx ourselves through seemingly innocuous details!

85 sats \ 0 replies \ @sorukumar 26 May
Stories told through numbers hit different.
For sure a masterclass in making abstract privacy risks feel real. Great share.

85 sats \ 0 replies \ @mary_imasuen 25 May
OMG! This puts so much into perspective. We need this message to be everywhere.

what follows after liberal democracy?

1961 sats \ 111 comments \ [@kepford](#)
27 May Politics_And_Law

TOP POST



This is something I've been thinking about. I don't believe you can go backwards. So by that I mean we're not going back to monarchy. I don't think we're going to communism. I don't think we're going to fascism. What is next? Is it something that doesn't currently exist? Is it something that's a combination of previous things in a new form? Are we ten years, fifty years, one hundred years, or five hundred years out?

From where I sit, the liberal post World War Two world is basically dying before our eyes. The more I think about it, the better I feel about this. That's not to say I am not concerned about what follows, because it could be worse. But it could be better. Ultimately I'm less convinced that we can build a system that fixes our problems. This is including Bitcoin. I'm not saying Bitcoin doesn't fix problems. It does, but it can't fix everything.

What do you think?

TOP COMMENTS

256 sats \ 26 replies \ [@Scoresby](#) 27 May

Every trend I see is toward governments exerting more control over the people within their borders.

Tech is aiding this (flock, internet surveillance, bank secrecy act, digital payments, cell phones).

Seems like that increases. So where does it go? I think it's a thing where the average person has far less freedom than even a decade ago. Rich people and people in charge probably get to do whatever they want.

164 sats \ 11 replies \ [@kepford](#) OP 27 May

But what is the story people believe that follows after the story of self-determination. Of globalism. Of democracy.

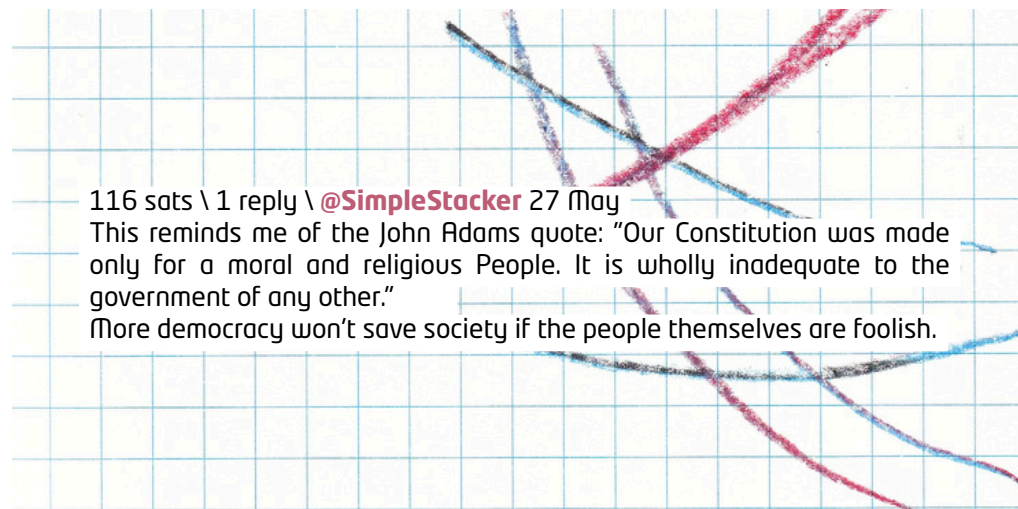
Rise in national identity? That seems to be a trend though I am not sure it sticks after the massive diversification of populations.

What moral guiding principles do people organize around? Faith in the ideals of democracy are on life support.

Do we drift into a techno neo-nationalism? Or do we see globalism take over and the idea of nations die?

78 sats \ 5 replies \ [@Scoresby](#) 27 May

I think the story becomes: "All those ideals (like liberty, democracy, equality, etc) were never real, they were just a plot by [fill in your villain] to control you. So now you shouldn't bother with any of that, just pay attention to your phone and have faith in bureaucracy."



116 sats \ 1 reply \ [@SimpleStacker](#) 27 May

This reminds me of the John Adams quote: "Our Constitution was made only for a moral and religious People. It is wholly inadequate to the government of any other."

More democracy won't save society if the people themselves are foolish.

114 sats \ 2 replies \ [@justin_shocknet](#) 27 May

You'll be begging for monarchy as you stare down the barrel of techno feudalism just like your ancestors did for the thousands of years before you

113 sats \ 1 reply \ [@Scoresby](#) 27 May

What will you be doing?

172 sats \ 0 replies \ [@justin_shocknet](#) 27 May

Enjoying my popcorn

152 sats \ 4 replies \ [@grayruby](#) 27 May

Some sort of techno autocracy disguised as democracy?